

# KEN CLEMONS

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## PERFORMANCE RECORD

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**Red Hat, \$7M. 160%.** Over plan three years running: 160%, then 128% of \$5M, then 137% of \$3.5M. President's Club.

**Alfresco, \$4M team target. 146%.** Full regional P&L, three enterprise AEs, my own \$1.5M inside the team number. President's Club.

**Couchbase, territory number. 135%.** Every dollar from a new customer, through the July 2021 IPO.

**Gigamon, \$750K region. 125%.** Directed the SDR, sales engineer and professional services against one regional number.

**Cloudflare, \$1M. 115%.** More than \$4M of pipeline across 35 named prospects, nearly all self-sourced.

**Adobe, \$2M annual. Cleared every year.** Over \$5M in enterprise revenue across the period. Two-time President's Club.

## SELLING OPEN SOURCE TO PLATFORM TEAMS

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The OpenShift and Kubernetes years taught me a sale that looks nothing like ordinary enterprise software.

- Champions arrive having already run the upstream project, so the technical argument is settled before I do. What remains is the commercial layer: support model, security posture, governance, upgrade path and production risk.
- Community is the top of the funnel. The user group I grew from 20 to 150 at Red Hat put me in front of practitioners months before any of them had a project, which is the only reliable way into an open source account.
- Build versus buy is the real competitor. Platform teams are capable of self-supporting, so the case gets made in engineering hours reclaimed and risk transferred.
- Buyer and funder sit in different rooms. Platform engineering and DevOps decide what gets adopted, while infrastructure leadership and finance decide what gets paid for. Both conversations run in parallel or the deal stalls at quarter end.
- Adoption is the leading indicator. At Red Hat I tracked cluster expansion and workload migration as the honest signal of whether an account would renew and grow, ahead of anything the CRM showed.
- Alfresco was open source enterprise content management, so Red Hat is the second place I have run this motion, and the pattern held in both.

## AGENTIC AI AND MCP

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This is the newest part of your platform and the part I have deliberately prepared for.

- Twenty AI certifications completed, spanning IBM AI Academy, Microsoft, AWS and LinkedIn Learning, with the AWS practitioner exam scheduled.
- My current quota at Analyst1 is carried on an AI-native platform sold into enterprises that push hard on data handling, model behavior and governance before they sign.
- EasyGuitar AI is an iOS application I designed and shipped in SwiftUI using Cursor, starting from no coding background. It showed me where these systems are dependable and where they only appear to be, which is the judgment a platform team needs before granting an agent access to production tooling.
- Give an agent access to production tooling in a regulated environment and the questions that follow are governance and observability questions. That puts the conversation with platform engineering, where I have spent most of my career.

## LANDMARK DEAL: ANTHEM, FIRST OPENSIFT AGREEMENT

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- Sold a Fortune 50 healthcare payer their first OpenShift agreement, putting container platform into an organization that had no production Kubernetes with us before that point.
- Net-new platform adoption of this kind is the hardest version of the open source sale. There is no existing footprint to expand, so the case rests entirely on modernization strategy and what the platform team believes it can operate.
- Anthem, Ascension, Mercy, BJC and Express Scripts followed as part of a healthcare cluster where architecture teams talk to each other, and early proof at one payer travels.

## ANCHOR DEAL: CENTENE, \$5M ANNUAL AGREEMENT, RED HAT

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- Opened cold into a Fortune 25 healthcare payer with no active project and no budget line for the category.
- Worked infrastructure, app dev, security and enterprise architecture as four separate threads, listening for what each group was measured on before proposing anything.
- Coordinated proofs of concept and architecture reviews end to end with solutions engineering and consulting.
- Assembled the modernization economics with the CFO organization, then cleared procurement and legal myself over several months.
- Displaced an incumbent embedded across the estate. Signed at \$5M annually with professional services attached, anchoring the year that closed at 160% of \$7M.

## BUILDING TERRITORIES FROM ZERO

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- Analyst1 is the live example. One of the first commercial hires covering thirteen Central states, landing SLB, American Airlines, Arvest Bank, Alliant Credit Union and Xcel Energy from nothing.
- Cloudflare finished at 115% of \$1M on pipeline I built myself, 35 named prospects and north of \$4M.
- Couchbase took an empty territory to roughly \$4M in pipeline, a 45% increase, on prospecting, technical discovery and partner work.
- The first sixty days are always the same shape. Segment the region, pick the twenty accounts that can actually close, find the partner already inside them, and write down the qualification bar before anyone forecasts against it.

## PROCESS AND TEAM IMPACT

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**Repeatable process.** MEDDPICC written down and enforced, weekly opportunity-level inspection in Salesforce and Clari, and a forecast that does not get quietly revised on the last day of a quarter.

**Mentoring peers.** At Alfresco I coached three enterprise AEs on pipeline reviews, deal strategy and negotiation while carrying my own number. At Analyst1 I wrote the tiering and qualification criteria the region now runs on.

**Cross-functional work.** Solutions engineering, development representatives, customer success, product, marketing and legal have all sat inside my account plans. At Analyst1 I feed competitive intelligence back to Product and Marketing from live deals.

**Community evangelism.** I grew the regional Red Hat user group from roughly 20 attendees to 150, presenting at many of the sessions. It became a dependable pipeline source and, more usefully, the way I earned standing with engineers who had no patience for a vendor pitch. I also helped found the NWA Tech Summit and work regional technology events as part of my standing prospecting rhythm.